SSC MTS 2021 Paper-I question paper with answers

15 July 2022 · Shift 2

68 questions as the Staff Selection Commission (SSC) printed them · answers from the official key · marking: +1 for a right answer, –0.25 for a wrong one

The other 32 of the paper's 100 questions are not reproduced: they need a figure or are printed as an image, or ask about formatting the source does not keep.

Try every question first: the answer key and the explanations follow the questions. Official answer-key notice: https://web.archive.org/web/20221017140324/https://ssc.nic.in/SSCFileServer/PortalManagement/UploadedFiles/Writeup_FinalAnswerKeyMTS2021_17102022.pdf

General English 25 questions

Q.1

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. My son turned a year older on his birthday recently _____ March 14.

(A) at
(B) over
(C) in
(D) on

Q.2

Parts of the following sentence have been given as options. One of them may contain an error. Select the part that contains the error from the given options. If you don’t find any error, mark ‘No error’ as your answer. If you want to help bees, make sure your family don’t use pesticides in your yard.

(A) use pesticides in your yard
(B) If you want to help bees,
(C) make sure your family don’t
(D) No error

Q.3

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. He didn't tell me anything _____ that he needed some money.

(A) despite
(B) except
(C) in spite
(D) though

Q.4

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words. The study of human mind and behaviour

(A) Paediatrics
(B) Botany
(C) Physiology
(D) Psychology

Q.5

Select the correctly spelt word.

(A) Librery
(B) Library
(C) Libraery
(D) Libarary

Q.6

Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No improvement required'. Water and minerals “presented to the soil” are absorbed by the roots..

(A) No improvement required
(B) presented at the soil
(C) present in the soil
(D) present for the soil

Q.7

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words. One who studies insect life

(A) Activist
(B) Cardiologist
(C) Entomologist
(D) Naturalist

Q.8

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. Give yourself a _____ and get some rest.

(A) Brake
(B) Break
(C) Blank
(D) Brick

Q.9

Select the most appropriate meaning of the underlined idiom in the given sentence. “Keep an eye on” your sister as she might run away.

(A) To help someone
(B) To stop caring
(C) To act superior to someone
(D) To watch over attentively

Q.10

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Definite

(A) precise
(B) Ample
(C) Inclusive
(D) General

Q.11

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. The commander abjured his _____to the king.

(A) regulation
(B) reliance
(C) sequence
(D) allegiance

Q.12

Select the option that corrects the misspelt words in the given sentence. There is a feling of hopelesness among the youth.

(A) There is a feeling of hoplesnes among the youth
(B) There is a fealing of hopelesnes among the youth.
(C) There is a feling of hopelesness among the youth.
(D) There is a feeling of hopelessness among the youth.

Q.13

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the underlined word in the given sentence. All these rules seem to be “irrelevant.”

(A) Reluctant
(B) Meaningful
(C) Meagre
(D) Incidental

Q.14

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. Mr. Pearson interrupted their harmless _____ and reminded them of the seriousness of the situation.

(A) field
(B) trouble
(C) guile
(D) chatter

Q.15

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Impressive

(A) Dramatic
(B) Significant
(C) Ordinary
(D) Industrious

Q.16

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. No spring chicken

(A) A person who is courageous
(B) A person who steals
(C) A person who is no longer young
(D) A person who lies

Q.17

Parts of the following sentence have been given as options. One of them may contain an error. Select the part that contains the error from the given options. If you don't find any error, mark 'No error' as your answer. The last time this competition was held at 2017.

(A) No error
(B) this competition was
(C) held at 2017
(D) The last time

Q.18

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Proficient

(A) Dominant
(B) Accomplished
(C) Modest
(D) Predictable

Q.19

Select the option that will improve the bracketed part of the sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No improvement required'. In the past, (he spent many an hours playing the harp across the) 5th Ave.

(A) he spent many an hour playing the harp across the
(B) he spent much hours playing the harp across the
(C) No improvement required
(D) he had spent many an hours playing the harp across the

Q.20

Parts of the following sentence have been given as options. One of them may contain an error. Select the part that contains the error from the given options. If you don't find any error, mark 'No error' as your answer. A part of me don't wanted you to go to the party.

(A) No error
(B) A part of me
(C) don't wanted you
(D) to go to the party

Q.21

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Starting and (1) _____ a positive daily morning routine is an investment and a way to do your best work every day. It also gives you structure, building forward-moving habits and creating momentum for the rest of the day. It helps you to (2) _____ priorities, limit procrastination, keep track of your goals. Your brain is at its (3) _____ in the morning. And you can get your best work and tasks done without struggle. But distractions can get the best of us. You get distracted and procrastinate. You make plans the previous day to get your most (4) _____ task done first thing in the morning, but you don't follow through on them. You are able to get things (5) _____ but not the right things.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 1.

(A) maintainable
(B) maintaining
(C) maintain
(D) maintenance

Q.22

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Starting and (1) _____ a positive daily morning routine is an investment and a way to do your best work every day. It also gives you structure, building forward-moving habits and creating momentum for the rest of the day. It helps you to (2) _____ priorities, limit procrastination, keep track of your goals. Your brain is at its (3) _____ in the morning. And you can get your best work and tasks done without struggle. But distractions can get the best of us. You get distracted and procrastinate. You make plans the previous day to get your most (4) _____ task done first thing in the morning, but you don't follow through on them. You are able to get things (5) _____ but not the right things.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 2.

(A) established
(B) establishing
(C) establishment
(D) establish

Q.23

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Starting and (1) _____ a positive daily morning routine is an investment and a way to do your best work every day. It also gives you structure, building forward-moving habits and creating momentum for the rest of the day. It helps you to (2) _____ priorities, limit procrastination, keep track of your goals. Your brain is at its (3) _____ in the morning. And you can get your best work and tasks done without struggle. But distractions can get the best of us. You get distracted and procrastinate. You make plans the previous day to get your most (4) _____ task done first thing in the morning, but you don't follow through on them. You are able to get things (5) _____ but not the right things.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 3.

(A) pick
(B) peak
(C) pique
(D) peek

Q.24

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Starting and (1) _____ a positive daily morning routine is an investment and a way to do your best work every day. It also gives you structure, building forward-moving habits and creating momentum for the rest of the day. It helps you to (2) _____ priorities, limit procrastination, keep track of your goals. Your brain is at its (3) _____ in the morning. And you can get your best work and tasks done without struggle. But distractions can get the best of us. You get distracted and procrastinate. You make plans the previous day to get your most (4) _____ task done first thing in the morning, but you don't follow through on them. You are able to get things (5) _____ but not the right things.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 4.

(A) importantly
(B) importance
(C) important
(D) Import

Q.25

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Starting and (1) _____ a positive daily morning routine is an investment and a way to do your best work every day. It also gives you structure, building forward-moving habits and creating momentum for the rest of the day. It helps you to (2) _____ priorities, limit procrastination, keep track of your goals. Your brain is at its (3) _____ in the morning. And you can get your best work and tasks done without struggle. But distractions can get the best of us. You get distracted and procrastinate. You make plans the previous day to get your most (4) _____ task done first thing in the morning, but you don't follow through on them. You are able to get things (5) _____ but not the right things.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 5.

(A) doable
(B) do
(C) did
(D) done

General Intelligence and Reasoning 19 questions

Q.1

Marks obtained by the seven students of a tuition class, P, Q, R, S, T, U and V, are mentioned. P scored second highest marks in the class. Marks scored by V were more than only one of the persons. S's score was more than T but less than P. Three people got higher than T and three got lesser than T. Neither R nor Q received the lowest marks. Given that no two students have the same marks, whose marks were the lowest?

(A) S
(B) U
(C) T
(D) V

Q.2

Read the given statements and conclusions carefully. Assuming that the information given in the statements is true, even if it appears to be at variance with commonly known facts, decide which of the given conclusions logically follow(s) from the statements. Statements: I. All X are A. II. Some R are X. Conclusions: I. Some A are R. II. All R are A.

(A) None of the conclusions follow
(B) Both conclusions I and II follow
(C) Only conclusion II follows
(D) Only conclusion I follows

Q.3

Read the given statements and conclusions carefully. Assuming that the information given in the statements is true, even if it appears to be at variance with commonly known facts, decide which of the given conclusions logically follow(s) from the statements. Statements: Some pillows are covers. All bedsheets are covers. Conclusions: I. All covers are bedsheets. II. Some pillows are bedsheets.

(A) Only conclusion II follows.
(B) Only conclusion I follows.
(C) Neither conclusion I nor II follow.
(D) Both conclusions I and II follow.

Q.4

Select the option that is related to the fifth term in the same way as the second term is related to the first term and the fourth term is related to the third term. CAT : FFA :: ANT : DSA :: SUN : ?

(A) VYU
(B) VZT
(C) VZU
(D) VZV

Q.5

Select the option that is related to the third letter-cluster in the same way as the second letter-cluster is related to the first letter-cluster. PRM : INL :: AJK : ?

(A) GFW
(B) GEX
(C) GFX
(D) GEW

Q.6

In a certain code language, 'TALENT' is written as 'VXNBPQ', and 'HORDIN' is written as 'JLTAKK'. How will 'AKRPQB' be written in that language?

(A) CTHMSY
(B) CHTNTY
(C) CHTMSY
(D) CITMSY

Q.7

Select the option that is related to the fifth term in the same way as the second term is related to the first term and the fourth term is related to the third term. ABROAD : RBADAO :: DEMAND : MEDDNA :: HONEST : ?

(A) NOHTSE
(B) NHOTES
(C) TESNOH
(D) NOHTES

Q.8

Select the option that is related to the fifth number in the same way as the second number is related to the first number and the fourth number is related to the third number. 121 : 145 :: 169 : 197 :: 256 : ?

(A) 325
(B) 280
(C) 290
(D) 288

Q.9

Which two numbers should be interchanged to make the given equation correct? $10 + 2 \times 12 \div 6 - 4 = 16$

(A) 6 and 12
(B) 2 and 10
(C) 10 and 4
(D) 2 and 4

Q.10

Select the number from among the given options that can replace the question mark (?) in the following series. 503, 509, 521, 539, ?

(A) 576
(B) 545
(C) 563
(D) 535

Q.11

Select the option that is related to the fifth number in the same way as the second number is related to the first number and the fourth number is related to the third number. 75 : 63 :: 189 : 171 :: 55 : ?

(A) 45
(B) 43
(C) 37
(D) 54

Q.12

Select the option in which the two numbers are related in the same way as are the numbers in the given number pair. 135 : 27

(A) 705 : 143
(B) 595 : 117
(C) 625 : 125
(D) 865 : 215

Q.14

In a certain code language, 'They play Football' is written as 'po la ta', 'They like playing' is written as 'la to zu', 'Football is best game' is written as 'xu po ba cu'.How will ‘Football’ be written in that language?

(A) po
(B) xu
(C) zu
(D) la

Q.15

A, B, C, D, E, F, G and H are sitting around a square table facing the centre of the table. Some of them are sitting at the corners while some are sitting at the exact centre of the sides. F sits third to the left of H. F sits at one of the corners. C sits second to the right of G. G does not sit at any of the corners. G is not an immediate neighbour of F. A is an immediate neighbour of B. A does not sit in any of the middles of the sides. Only three people sit between A and D. Who sits second to the left of D?

(A) G
(B) F
(C) E
(D) A

Q.19

In a certain code language, 'ENJOY' is coded as '25' and 'DOCTOR' is coded as '36'. How will 'MILLION' be coded in that language?

(A) 39
(B) 49
(C) 51
(D) 64

Q.20

What will come in the place of '?' in the following equation, if '×' and ' – ' are interchanged and also '+' and '÷' are interchanged? 10 × 4 + 2 – 5 ÷ 4 = ?

(A) 6
(B) 8
(C) 4
(D) 2

Q.22

Five people A, B, C, D and E are sitting in a straight row facing North. E is sitting immediately next to D, C is sitting immediately next to B, and B is not sitting with A who is on the left end of the bench. C is in the second position from the right. E is to the right of D and A. E and C are sitting together. What is the position of E?

(A) Immediate neighbour of both A and B
(B) Immediate neighbour of both C and A
(C) Immediate neighbour of both D and B
(D) Immediate neighbour of both D and C

Q.23

In a certain code language, 'GROW' is written as 'RGWO', 'PINK' is written as 'IPKN'. How will 'HALD' be written in that code language?

(A) DLAH
(B) AHDL
(C) HADL
(D) AHLD

Q.24

Select the letter-cluster from among the given options that can replace the question mark (?) in the following series.BY, ?, DW, EV, FU

(A) CE
(B) AX
(C) AU
(D) CX

General Awareness 24 questions

Q.1

The breaking up of the rocks on the earth's surface is called _____.

(A) conurbation
(B) weathering
(C) desertification
(D) flacking

Q.2

The foundation stone of 'Banas Dairy Sankul' scheme in Uttar Pradesh was laid by _____.

(A) Narendra Singh Tomar
(B) Amit Shah
(C) Smriti Irani
(D) Narendra Modi

Q.3
Which of the following statements is INCORRECT?

(A) Fiat money is issued without any backing of an equivalent amount of gold or silver.
(B) Money Multiplier is the ratio of money supply to the reserve money.
(C) In Time Deposits, money can be withdrawn only after maturity or with a penalty before maturity.
(D) Vault cash is also a part of the money supply.

Q.4
Which of the following statements is INCORRECT?

(A) Metals react with oxygen to form basic oxides.
(B) Non-metals are malleable.
(C) Non-metals do not produce any sound.
(D) Metals have low ionisation enthalpy.

Q.5
Which of the following dance forms is performed by devotees during the ceremonial worship of Murugan, the Tamil God of War?

(A) Mayilattom
(B) Therukoothu
(C) Kavadi Aattam
(D) Kummi

Q.6
Who among the following administers the union territories of India?

(A) Chief Minister
(B) President
(C) Prime Minister
(D) Member of Legislative Assembly

Q.7
Who among the following formed the Tattvabodhini Sabha in 1839?

(A) Ramakrishna Paramahamsa
(B) Debendranath Tagore
(C) Swami Dayanand Saraswati
(D) Keshab Chandra Sen

Q.8
Who among the following was given the title of ‘Uttarapatha Swamin’?

(A) Mahipala
(B) Devapala
(C) Dharmapala
(D) Gopala

Q.9
Pandit Ravi Shankar is famous for playing which of the following instruments?

(A) Santoor
(B) Sarod
(C) Veena
(D) Sitar

Q.10
Who among the following dancers was the first Odissi dancer of foreign origin to be conferred the Padma Shri in 2006?

(A) Eri Nakamura
(B) Ileana Citaristi
(C) Mrinalini Sarabhai
(D) Sofia Boutella

Q.11
Ocean acidification is the ongoing decrease in the pH of the Earth’s oceans, caused by the uptake of _____ from the atmosphere.

(A) methane
(B) carbon dioxide
(C) nitrogen
(D) argon

Q.12
Which Act was passed in 1929 prohibiting marriage of girls below 14 and boys below 18 years of age?

(A) Pitt's India Act
(B) Sharda Act
(C) Vernacular Press Act
(D) Rowlett Act

Q.13
Vinegar used in cooking contains which of the following compounds?

(A) Methanol
(B) Sodium sulphate
(C) Ammonia
(D) Acetic acid

Q.14
With respect to communication, 'Doordarshan' in India is a _____.

(A) national web browser
(B) national radio channel
(C) national television channel
(D) national newspaper

Q.15
How many medals in total did India win at the Summer Olympics 2020 (played in 2021)?

(A) 3
(B) 6
(C) 7
(D) 5

Q.17
Article 23 and Article 24 of the Indian Constitution deal with which of the following Fundamental Right?

(A) Right against Exploitation
(B) Right to Freedom
(C) Right to Equality
(D) Right to Freedom of Religion

Q.18
Who among the following authors wrote 'Train to Pakistan'?

(A) Kiran Desai
(B) RK Narayan
(C) Arundhati Roy
(D) Khushwant Singh

Q.19
Kumarakom boat race is the most admired boat race to take place on the Vembanad Lake in September during the _____ festival.

(A) Lohri
(B) Deepavali
(C) Nowruz
(D) Onam

Q.20
Where does the Alaknanda river join the Bhagirathi river in India?

(A) Devprayag
(B) Dehradun
(C) Prayagraj
(D) Champawat

Q.21
Ain-i-Akbari which is the third volume of the book 'Akbar Nama' deals with _____.

(A) Akbar's ancestors
(B) Akbar's events of Akbar's reign
(C) Akbar's religion
(D) Akbar's administration

Q.22
The Indian cricket team won the final match of the 2011 ICC ODI Cricket World Cup Championship by defeating the team from which country?

(A) Australia
(B) Pakistan
(C) Sri Lanka
(D) New Zealand

Q.23

Sanjiv Kapoor has been appointed as the new Chief Executive Officer of _____. His appointment will be effective from 4 April 2022.

(A) Jet Airways
(B) AirAsia
(C) GoAir
(D) SpiceJet

Q.24

India shares its land boundary with _____ in the north-west.

(A) Myanmar
(B) Bhutan
(C) Bangladesh
(D) Afghanistan

Q.25

As per Census 2011, which of the following was the most literate state of India?

(A) Chhattisgarh
(B) Bihar
(C) Kerala
(D) Punjab

Answer key

General English

Q.1 **(D)**	Q.2 **(C)**	Q.3 **(B)**	Q.4 **(D)**	Q.5 **(B)**	Q.6 **(C)**
Q.7 **(C)**	Q.8 **(B)**	Q.9 **(D)**	Q.10 **(A)**	Q.11 **(D)**	Q.12 **(D)**
Q.13 **(B)**	Q.14 **(D)**	Q.15 **(C)**	Q.16 **(C)**	Q.17 **(C)**	Q.18 **(B)**
Q.19 **(A)**	Q.20 **(C)**	Q.21 **(B)**	Q.22 **(D)**	Q.23 **(B)**	Q.24 **(C)**
Q.25 **(D)**					

General Intelligence and Reasoning

Q.1 **(B)**	Q.2 **(D)**	Q.3 **(C)**	Q.4 **(C)**	Q.5 **(A)**	Q.6 **(C)**
Q.7 **(A)**	Q.8 **(C)**	Q.9 **(D)**	Q.10 **(C)**	Q.11 **(A)**	Q.12 **(C)**
Q.14 **(A)**	Q.15 **(C)**	Q.19 **(B)**	Q.20 **(C)**	Q.22 **(D)**	Q.23 **(B)**
Q.24 **(D)**					

General Awareness

Q.1 **(B)**	Q.2 **(D)**	Q.3 **(D)**	Q.4 **(B)**	Q.5 **(C)**	Q.6 **(B)**
Q.7 **(B)**	Q.8 **(C)**	Q.9 **(D)**	Q.10 **(B)**	Q.11 **(B)**	Q.12 **(B)**
Q.13 **(D)**	Q.14 **(C)**	Q.15 **(C)**	Q.17 **(A)**	Q.18 **(D)**	Q.19 **(D)**
Q.20 **(A)**	Q.21 **(D)**	Q.22 **(C)**	Q.23 **(A)**	Q.24 **(D)**	Q.25 **(C)**

Explanations

General English

Q.1 · Answer (D) on

Dates take 'on': 'on March 14'. 'In' goes with months and years, and 'at' with clock times.

Q.2 · Answer (C) make sure your family don't

SSC's key gives 'make sure your family don't': taken as one household, 'family' takes a singular verb, 'make sure your family doesn't use pesticides'. British usage also allows a plural verb with a collective noun, but the exam follows the singular rule.

Q.3 · Answer (B) except

'Except' means apart from: he told me nothing apart from the fact that he needed money. 'Despite' and 'in spite (of)' show contrast, and 'though' joins two clauses.

Q.4 · Answer (D) Psychology

Psychology is the study of the human mind and behaviour. Paediatrics is the branch of medicine that deals with children, physiology the study of how the body works, and botany the study of plants.

Q.5 · Answer (B) Library

The correct spelling is 'library'.

Q.6 · Answer (C) present in the soil

The adjective 'present' means existing in a place: water and minerals 'present in the soil'. 'Presented to' means formally given to, which does not fit.

Q.7 · Answer (C) Entomologist

An entomologist studies insects. A cardiologist treats diseases of the heart, and a naturalist studies nature in general.

Q.8 · Answer (B) Break

A 'break' is a short rest: 'give yourself a break'. A 'brake' is a device for slowing a vehicle; the two words sound alike.

Q.9 · Answer (D) To watch over attentively

To 'keep an eye on' someone is to watch them carefully.

Q.10 · Answer (A) precise

'Definite' means clear and exact: 'precise'. 'General' is nearly its opposite, and 'ample' means more than enough.

Q.11 · Answer (D) allegiance

To 'abjure' is to renounce solemnly, and what one owes a king is 'allegiance', loyalty: the commander renounced his allegiance to the king.

Q.12 · Answer (D) There is a feeling of hopelessness among the youth.

'Feeling' has a double 'e', and 'hopelessness' is 'hope' + 'less' + 'ness', with a double 's' twice.

Q.13 · Answer (B) Meaningful

'Irrelevant' means unconnected with the matter or unimportant; of the options, its opposite is 'meaningful'. 'Incidental' is close to it in sense.

Q.14 · Answer (D) chatter

'Chatter' is light, idle talk, which suits 'harmless' and contrasts with the seriousness of the situation. 'Guile' is cunning.

Q.15 · Answer (C) Ordinary

'Impressive' means striking or remarkable; its opposite is 'ordinary'. 'Dramatic' and 'significant' are close to it in sense.

Q.16 · Answer (C) A person who is no longer young
'No spring chicken' describes a person who is no longer young.

Q.17 · Answer (C) held at 2017
Years take 'in', not 'at': 'held in 2017'.

Q.18 · Answer (B) Accomplished
'Proficient' means highly skilled: 'accomplished'. 'Dominant' means most powerful, and 'modest' and 'predictable' are unrelated.

Q.19 · Answer (A) he spent many an hour playing the harp across the
'Many a' (or 'many an') takes a singular noun: 'many an hour'. 'Much' goes with uncountable nouns, and 'hours' is countable.

Q.20 · Answer (C) don’t wanted you
After 'do' the verb stays in its base form, and the past takes 'did': 'A part of me didn't want you to go to the party.'

Q.21 · Answer (B) maintaining
The blank pairs with the gerund 'starting', so it too must be an -ing form: 'Starting and maintaining a positive daily morning routine'.

Q.22 · Answer (D) establish
'Helps you to' is followed by the base form, as are 'limit' and 'keep' later in the list: 'establish priorities'.

Q.23 · Answer (B) peak
To be 'at its peak' is to be at its best. A 'peek' is a quick look and 'pique' a feeling of irritation.

Q.24 · Answer (C) important
An adjective is needed before 'task': 'your most important task'.

Q.25 · Answer (D) done
'Get things done' takes the past participle after 'get' and its object, meaning to have them completed.

General Intelligence and Reasoning

Q.1 · Answer (B) U
Three score above T and three below, so T is fourth; V, above only one person, is sixth; P is second, and S, between T and P, third. Q, R and U take first, fifth and seventh, and as neither Q nor R is last, U has the lowest marks.

Q.2 · Answer (D) Only conclusion I follows
Some R are X and every X is an A, so those R are A: some A are R (I). The R that are not X may lie outside A, so II does not follow.

Q.3 · Answer (C) Neither conclusion I nor II follow.
All bedsheets are covers, but there may be covers that are not bedsheets, so I does not follow. Pillows and bedsheets are each linked only to covers and need not overlap, so II does not follow either.

Q.4 · Answer (C) VZU
The letters move +3, +5 and +7, wrapping round after Z: C → F, A → F, T → A and A → D, N → S, T → A. So S → V, U → Z and N → U: VZU.

Q.5 · Answer (A) GFW
Each letter moves 4 places back and the cluster is reversed: PRM → LNI → INL. Likewise AJK → WFG (A wraps round to W) → GFW.

Q.6 · Answer (C) CHTMSY
The letters move +2 and −3 in turn, wrapping round the alphabet: TALENT → VXNBPQ and HORDIN → JLTAKK. So AKRPQB → CHTMSY.

Q.7 · Answer (A) NOHTSE
The first and third letters swap places, and so do the fourth and sixth: ABROAD → RBADAO and DEMAND → MEDDNA. So HONEST → NOHTSE.

Q.8 · Answer (C) 290
Each first number is a square, and its pair is the next square plus 1: $11^2 \rightarrow 12^2 + 1 = 145$ and $13^2 \rightarrow 14^2 + 1 = 197$. So $16^2 \rightarrow 17^2 + 1 = 290$.

Q.9 · Answer (D) 2 and 4
After interchanging 2 and 4: $10 + 4 \times 12 \div 6 - 2 = 10 + 8 - 2 = 16$.

Q.10 · Answer (C) 563
The differences are 6, 12, 18 and 24: 539 + 24 = 563.

Q.11 · Answer (A) 45
Each number minus the sum of its digits gives its pair: 75 − 12 = 63 and 189 − 18 = 171. So 55 − 10 = 45.

Q.12 · Answer (C) 625 : 125
The first number is 5 times the second: $135 = 5 \times 27$, and likewise $625 = 5 \times 125$.

Q.14 · Answer (A) po
'Football' is in the first and third sentences, and the only code they share is 'po'.

Q.15 · Answer (C) E
Facing the centre, a person's left is the next seat clockwise. Numbering the seats clockwise from F's corner as 0, H is at 5 (F is third to H's left), G, in a middle seat not next to F, at 3, and C, second to G's right, at 1. A and D sit at the opposite corners 2 and 6; A needs a free neighbour for B, so A is at 6 with B at 7, D is at 2 and E at 4, second to the left of D.

Q.19 · Answer (B) 49
Each word is coded as the square of its number of letters: ENJOY has 5 ($5^2 = 25$) and DOCTOR 6 ($6^2 = 36$). MILLION has 7: $7^2 = 49$.

Q.20 · Answer (C) 4
After the interchanges: $10 - 4 \div 2 \times 5 + 4 = 10 - 10 + 4 = 4$.

Q.22 · Answer (D) Immediate neighbour of both D and C
A is at the left end and C second from the right. E sits next to C, with D immediately on E's left, so E cannot be at the right end (D would need C's seat): E is in the middle, D second from the left and B at the right end. The row is A, D, E, C, B, so E's neighbours are D and C.

Q.23 · Answer (B) AHDL
Each pair of letters is swapped: GR OW → RG WO and PI NK → IP KN. So HA LD → AH DL: AHDL.

Q.24 · Answer (D) CX
The first letters run B, C, D, E, F and the second Y, X, W, V, U: CX.

General Awareness

Q.1 · Answer (B) weathering
Weathering is the breaking down of rocks in place at the earth's surface by physical, chemical and biological processes. A conurbation is a merged urban area, and desertification the spread of desert conditions.

Q.2 · Answer (D) Narendra Modi
Prime Minister Narendra Modi laid the foundation stone of the Banas Dairy Sankul, a milk processing plant at Karkhiyaon in Varanasi, on 23 December 2021.

Q.3 · Answer (D) Vault cash is also a part of the money supply.
Money supply counts the currency held by the public and deposits, not the cash that banks keep in their own vaults; vault cash is part of reserve money (high powered money) instead. The other three statements are correct.

Q.4 · Answer (B) Non-metals are malleable.
Non-metals are generally brittle, not malleable: solid non-metals such as sulphur break when hammered. Metals form basic oxides, ring when struck where non-metals do not, and lose electrons easily (low ionisation enthalpy).

Q.5 · Answer (C) Kavadi Aattam
Kavadi Aattam is the ceremonial offering in which devotees of Murugan dance carrying a kavadi, a decorated arch borne on the shoulders. Mayilattam, the peacock dance, is also performed in Murugan temples, but by trained dancers rather than as the devotees' own offering.

Q.6 · Answer (B) President
Under Article 239 every union territory is administered by the President, acting through an administrator he or she appoints.

Q.7 · Answer (B) Debendranath Tagore
Debendranath Tagore founded the Tattvabodhini Sabha in Calcutta in 1839 to spread Rammohun Roy's ideas; he later led the Brahmo Samaj.

Q.8 · Answer (C) Dharmapala
The Pala king Dharmapala, who placed his nominee Chakrayudha on the throne of Kannauj, is called 'Uttarapathasvamin', lord of the north, by the Gujarati poet Soddhala.

Q.9 · Answer (D) Sitar
Pandit Ravi Shankar was a sitar player who took Indian classical music to audiences around the world; he received the Bharat Ratna in 1999.

Q.10 · Answer (B) Ileana Citaristi
Ileana Citaristi, born in Italy and based in Bhubaneswar, an Odissi and Chhau dancer, received the Padma Shri in 2006.

Q.11 · Answer (B) carbon dioxide
Sea water absorbs carbon dioxide from the air, forming carbonic acid, which lowers its pH.

Q.12 · Answer (B) Sharda Act
The Child Marriage Restraint Act, 1929, known as the Sarda (Sharda) Act after Har Bilas Sarda, who moved it, fixed the minimum age of marriage at 14 for girls and 18 for boys.

Q.13 · Answer (D) Acetic acid
Vinegar is a dilute solution, about 5-8 per cent, of acetic (ethanoic) acid in water.

Q.14 · Answer (C) national television channel
Doordarshan is India's public service television broadcaster, part of Prasar Bharati; All India Radio (Akashvani) is the national radio service.

Q.15 · Answer (C) 7
At the Tokyo 2020 Olympics, held in 2021, India won 7 medals: 1 gold (Neeraj Chopra in the javelin), 2 silver and 4 bronze.

Q.17 · Answer (A) Right against Exploitation
Articles 23 and 24 form the Right against Exploitation: Article 23 bans human trafficking and forced labour, and Article 24 bans employing children below 14 in factories, mines and other hazardous work.

Q.18 · Answer (D) Khushwant Singh
'Train to Pakistan' (1956), a novel about the Partition, is by Khushwant Singh.

Q.19 · Answer (D) Onam
The Kumarakom boat race, also called the Sree Narayana Jayanthi boat race, is held on Vembanad Lake in Kerala in the Onam season.

Q.20 · Answer (A) Devprayag
The Alaknanda and the Bhagirathi meet at Devprayag in Uttarakhand, and from there the river is called the Ganga.

Q.21 · Answer (D) Akbar’s administration
The Ain-i-Akbari, the third volume of Abul Fazl's Akbarnama, describes Akbar's administration: his court, army, revenue system and provinces. The first two volumes cover his ancestors and the events of his reign.

Q.22 · Answer (C) Sri Lanka
India beat Sri Lanka by six wickets in the final at the Wankhede Stadium, Mumbai, on 2 April 2011.

Q.23 · Answer (A) Jet Airways
Sanjiv Kapoor, formerly of Vistara and SpiceJet, was named chief executive of Jet Airways by its new owners, the Jalan-Kalrock consortium, in March 2022, with effect from 4 April 2022.

Q.24 · Answer (D) Afghanistan
Pakistan and Afghanistan are India's land neighbours in the north-west. Bhutan lies to the north-east, and Bangladesh and Myanmar to the east.

Q.25 · Answer (C) Kerala
Kerala had the highest literacy rate of any state in the 2011 Census, about 94 per cent; Bihar had the lowest.

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